FREE · THETECHHUT.CO/CV-PACK

A robot reads your CV first. *Here is which one.*

Safaricom runs Oracle. Britam runs Taleo. M-KOPA and Andela run Ashby. Tala runs Lever. Each of those systems reads your CV differently, and formatting that sails through one gets you silently filtered by another. We checked the live job feed of every major Kenyan tech employer we track and wrote down what we found.

PART ONE · THE MAP

Who runs what

Every row was confirmed against the employer's own live careers feed in October 2026. Employers do change systems, so treat this as a snapshot.

EMPLOYER	SYSTEM	WHAT THAT MEANS FOR YOU
Safaricom	Oracle Recruiting Cloud	Your uploaded CV is parsed, then you re-enter everything by hand anyway. The form fields are what get searched, not your PDF. Budget 40 minutes for a first application.
Britam	Oracle Taleo	Oldest system on this list. Hates tables, columns, headers and footers. Build a profile once and reuse it; Taleo keeps it between applications.
M-KOPA	Ashby	Clean parse, short form, structured screening questions. Your answers to those questions matter more than your CV design.
Andela	Ashby	Skills are matched as discrete tags, so name your stack explicitly: "React", not "modern frontend frameworks".
One Acre Fund	Greenhouse	Parses a plain PDF almost perfectly. Keyword search runs on the parsed text, so the words in your CV are the words recruiters find you by.
Jumia	Greenhouse	Same engine. Expect a cover-letter field: usually optional, and usually read when a shortlist is close.
Zipline	Greenhouse	Posts Kenya roles alongside global ones on one board. Filter by location before you apply.
GiveDirectly	Greenhouse	Heavy on structured application questions. Written answers carry real weight here.
Tala	Lever	Lever auto-fills the form from your CV or LinkedIn. **Check what it filled in**: a bad parse is the most common silent rejection.
Apollo Agriculture	Lever	Same auto-fill. Lever also de-duplicates applicants, so a second application to the same role does nothing.

EMPLOYER	SYSTEM	WHAT THAT MEANS FOR YOU
Sun King	Pinpoint	Short, forgiving form. Being specific about your county and language skills helps.
Watu Credit	JazzHR	Plain form, light parsing. A screener mostly sees your CV itself, so the first third of page one does the work.
ACRE Africa	Careers page + email	No ATS: a human opens your mail. Your subject line and first two sentences are the whole filter.
Canonical	Greenhouse	Fully remote, hires "home based, EMEA", which includes Kenya. Written application essays are formally scored.

> **The pattern worth memorising:** if the apply link goes to **oraclecloud.com** or **taleo.net**, you are in a form-first system: the fields are everything. If it goes to **greenhouse.io**, **lever.co**, **ashbyhq.com** or **pinpointhq.com**, your CV file is parsed and searched directly, so formatting is everything.

PART TWO · THE RULES

Six formatting rules that satisfy every system above

RULE 01

One column. Always.

Two-column CVs, the ones with a coloured sidebar, are read left to right across the page by most parsers. Your job titles end up merged with your skills list.

RULE 02

No tables, text boxes or icons.

Taleo drops table contents entirely. Icons become nothing: if a phone icon replaces the word "Phone", some parsers lose your number. Write the words.

RULE 03

Use the boring headings.

"Work Experience", "Education", "Skills", "Certifications". Parsers match headings against a fixed list; a creative heading means that section is never categorised.

RULE 04

Dates as MM/YYYY, right of the role.

03/2024 – Present. Not "Mar '24 to date". Dates are how systems calculate your years of experience, and that number is often a hard filter.

RULE 05

Mirror the posting's exact nouns.

If the ad says "Node.js", write Node.js, not NodeJS. Keyword matching is literal. Put the stack in a Skills line and inside the bullet where you used it.

RULE 06

Submit a PDF, unless asked for Word.

Modern systems parse PDF cleanly; Taleo and some Oracle set-ups still prefer .docx. Keep both, named **Firstname-Lastname-Role.pdf**, never "CV final v3".

> **The 60-second test:** open your CV, select all, copy, and paste into a blank plain-text note. That is almost exactly what the parser sees. If the order is scrambled, your dates vanish or your name is missing, that is your rejection, before any human was involved.

Copy this structure

Replace the content, keep the order and the headings. It is deliberately plain. An editable Word version is at thetechhut.co/cv-pack.

```
FIRSTNAME LASTNAME
Backend Engineer
Nairobi, Kenya | +254 7XX XXX XXX | you@email.com
linkedin.com/in/yourname | github.com/yourname

SUMMARY
Backend engineer with 4 years building payment and lending
services in Kenya. Node.js, PostgreSQL, AWS. Shipped an
M-Pesa Daraja integration handling 12,000 transactions a day.

SKILLS
Languages: JavaScript (Node.js), Python, SQL
Frameworks: Express, NestJS, Django
Data: PostgreSQL, Redis, MongoDB
Cloud and tooling: AWS (EC2, RDS, Lambda), Docker, GitHub Actions
Integrations: M-Pesa Daraja API, Stripe, Africa's Talking

WORK EXPERIENCE

Backend Engineer                              03/2024 - Present
Company Name, Nairobi, Kenya
- Cut checkout failures 31% by rebuilding the M-Pesa callback
  handler with idempotency keys and a retry queue.
- Moved 18 services onto GitHub Actions, taking deploys from
  45 minutes to 6.
- Owned the PostgreSQL schema for a loan book of 240,000 users.

Software Developer                            01/2022 - 02/2024
Company Name, Nairobi, Kenya
- Built the customer API used by 3 mobile clients, 1.2M monthly
  requests, 99.9% uptime.
- Reduced median query time from 820ms to 140ms by adding
  composite indexes and removing N+1 reads.

EDUCATION

BSc Computer Science                          09/2017 - 11/2021
University Name, Nairobi, Kenya

CERTIFICATIONS
AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Associate, 2025
```

> **Every bullet is X-Y-Z:** did X, measured by Y, by doing Z. "Cut checkout failures 31% (Y) by rebuilding the M-Pesa callback handler (Z)". A bullet with no number in it is a sentence a screener skips.

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